

# B.A. in Music roadmap: four years

First-year entry, eight semesters · Music office: [music@csueastbay.edu](mailto:music@csueastbay.edu), (510) 885-3135



This roadmap  
online

| Degree                    | Entry                          | Total     | Catalog   |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| Bachelor of Arts in Music | First-year, fall B (odd years) | 120 units | 2027–2028 |

## 01 Degree at a glance

| Component                                     | Units      |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------|
| Lower-division music                          | 15         |
| Upper-division music                          | 18         |
| Applied study and ensembles                   | 9          |
| Music electives                               | 12         |
| General education and graduation requirements | 48         |
| Free electives*                               | 18         |
| <b>Total</b>                                  | <b>120</b> |

\*These vary depending on each student’s path through the GE requirements and free electives, up to 120 units.

## 02 Before the first semester

Applied lessons begin after an applied area placement, which is an audition on the student’s instrument or voice or a creative portfolio in composition or music production. Ensemble placement happens at the first meeting of each ensemble.

General education paths differ from student to student. The GE courses shown are one typical selection for music majors. Students build their own GE plan with an advisor.

String players take Chamber Orchestra (MUS 365) as their Major Performing Ensemble.

The Certificate in Music Education counts within the 120 units of the B.A. Its roadmap shows the semester placement of the certificate courses.

## 03 Semester by semester

☐ Music    ☐ General education

### Lower division

#### First semester (fall B)

| Course                | Title                                        | Units     |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| ENGL 100              | College Writing: Stretch I                   | 3         |
| ENGL 109              | College Writing Lab                          | 1         |
| ES 121                | People’s History I                           | 3         |
| HIST 110              | United States to 1877                        | 3         |
| MUS 108               | The Language of Music                        | 3         |
| MUS 261–269           | Applied Music Study (applied area placement) | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                    | 1         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                              | <b>15</b> |

#### Second semester (spring B)

| Course                | Title                                   | Units     |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------|
| ENGL 101              | College Writing: Stretch II             | 2         |
| ENGL 109              | College Writing Lab                     | 1         |
| COMM 100              | Oral Communication                      | 3         |
| MATH 118E             | Mathematics for the Arts and Humanities | 4         |
| MUS 111               | Music Theory I                          | 2         |
| MUS 115               | Aural Skills I                          | 1         |
| MUS 118               | Keyboard Musicianship I                 | 1         |
| MUS 261–269           | Applied Music Study                     | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble               | 1         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                         | <b>16</b> |

### Third semester (fall A)

| Course                | Title                            | Units     |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|
| PHIL 100              | Critical Thinking                | 3         |
| GE 3B                 | Humanities                       | 3         |
| GE 5A                 | Physical and Biological Sciences | 3         |
| MUS 112               | Music Theory II                  | 2         |
| MUS 116               | Aural Skills II                  | 1         |
| MUS 119               | Keyboard Musicianship II         | 1         |
| MUS 381               | Essentials of Music Technology   | 3         |
| MUS 261–269           | Applied Music Study              | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble        | 1         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                  | <b>18</b> |

### Upper division

### Fifth semester (fall B)

| Course                | Title                                         | Units     |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| UD GE 4               | Upper-division Social and Behavioral Sciences | 3         |
| MUS 304               | World Music & Culture                         | 3         |
| MUS 410               | 20th and 21st C Styles and Techniques         | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Music Study (jury)                    | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                     | 1         |
|                       | Music electives                               | 4         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                               | <b>15</b> |

### Seventh semester (fall A)

| Course                | Title                           | Units     |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------|-----------|
| MUS 323               | Topics in Western Music History | 3         |
| MUS 312               | Form and Analysis               | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Music Study (jury)      | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble       | 1         |
| MUS 360–369           | Chamber Ensemble                | 1         |
|                       | Free electives                  | 3         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                 | <b>12</b> |

### Fourth semester (spring A)

| Course                | Title                                     | Units     |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------|
| GE 5B–C               | Physical and Biological Sciences with lab | 4         |
| GE 6                  | Ethnic Studies                            | 3         |
| MUS 202               | Writing About Music                       | 3         |
| MUS 211               | Music Theory III                          | 2         |
| MUS 215               | Aural Skills III                          | 1         |
| MUS 218               | Keyboard Musicianship III                 | 1         |
| MUS 261–269           | Applied Music Study                       | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                 | 1         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                           | <b>16</b> |

### Sixth semester (spring B)

| Course                | Title                                             | Units     |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| UD GE 5               | Upper-division Science and Quantitative Reasoning | 3         |
| UWR                   | University Writing Requirement                    | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Music Study (jury)                        | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble                         | 1         |
|                       | Free electives                                    | 6         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                                                   | <b>14</b> |

### Eighth semester (spring A)

| Course                | Title                      | Units     |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|-----------|
| MUS 324               | History of American Music  | 3         |
| MUS 461–469           | Applied Music Study (jury) | 1         |
| MUS 351–359           | Major Performing Ensemble  | 1         |
|                       | Free electives             | 9         |
| <b>Semester total</b> |                            | <b>14</b> |

## 04 Music electives

Students choose 12 units. Up to 4 additional units of Applied Music Study, 4 additional units of Major Performing Ensembles, and 7 additional units of Chamber Ensembles also count toward electives.

#### Music education

|         |                                        |
|---------|----------------------------------------|
| MUS 331 | Foundations of Music Education, 3      |
| MUS 335 | Technology for Music Educators, 3      |
| MUS 431 | Elementary Music Teaching Methods, 3   |
| MUS 432 | Instrumental Music Teaching Methods, 3 |
| MUS 433 | Choral Music Teaching Methods, 3       |
| MUS 445 | Piano Pedagogy, 2                      |
| MUS 446 | Vocal Pedagogy, 2                      |
| MUS 495 | Music Education Practicum, 1           |

|         |                                           |
|---------|-------------------------------------------|
| MUS 497 | Contemporary Issues in Music Education, 3 |
|---------|-------------------------------------------|

#### Conducting

|         |                            |
|---------|----------------------------|
| MUS 341 | Basic Conducting, 3        |
| MUS 441 | Intermediate Conducting, 3 |

#### Composition and music production

|         |                                                           |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| MUS 280 | Composers Workshop, 1                                     |
| MUS 412 | Contrapuntal Techniques, 3                                |
| MUS 414 | Contemporary Orchestration and Arranging, 3               |
| MUS 415 | MIDI Orchestration, 3                                     |
| MUS 485 | Advanced Sound Design I: Sampling, Editing, and Mixing, 3 |

|         |                                                                                         |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MUS 486 | Advanced Sound Design II: Synthesis, Modulation & Creative Digital Signal Processing, 3 |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

#### History and global music

|         |                           |
|---------|---------------------------|
| MUS 305 | Global Hip-Hop, 3         |
| MUS 326 | Topics in Global Music, 3 |

#### Entrepreneurship and research

|         |                                 |
|---------|---------------------------------|
| MUS 303 | Entrepreneurship in the Arts, 3 |
| MUS 490 | Independent Study, 1–3          |
| MUS 498 | Internship, 1–3                 |

#### Performance

|         |                             |
|---------|-----------------------------|
| MUS 317 | Improvisation Techniques, 1 |
|---------|-----------------------------|